

Case No. 2:25-cv-00405-RMG-MGB

On **February 14, 2025 (ECF No. 16)**, Plaintiff submitted to the Court the full email correspondence between herself and former counsel **Bonnie Travaglio Hunt** surrounding Ms. Hunt's withdrawal from representation. These materials were entered into the record to ensure transparency regarding communications relevant to the withdrawal and subsequent representation issues.

Following the Court's approval of subpoenas (ECF No. 73), Plaintiff sought to obtain limited, non-privileged information from Hunt Law, LLC to determine whether communications or transactions occurred between **Curtiss-Wright**, its counsel, or related third parties and Hunt during the relevant period. These subpoenas were authorized as part of legitimate discovery into possible conflicts of interest, obstruction, and misconduct.

Due to recurring delays in issuance and return of subpoenas from the Clerk of Court, Plaintiff filed multiple Certificates of Service corresponding to the administrative timeline. On **October 9, 2025**, Plaintiff personally delivered the subpoena to the **South Carolina Secretary of State** in Columbia, traveling more than two hours to ensure prompt and direct service in accordance with the Court's prior order.

III. PATTERN OF CONVOLUTING THE RECORD AND REPETITIVE FILINGS

Plaintiff notes that Attorney Andrew W. Countryman has demonstrated a consistent pattern of **convoluting the record** through repetitive and irrelevant filings that reintroduce issues from unrelated proceedings, including the dismissed Charleston County Common Pleas case (2025-CP-10-03145). His filings routinely include personal accusations and extraneous commentary designed to confuse the procedural record and undermine orderly discovery.

The present objection continues that pattern by injecting immaterial references to state court restraining order proceedings and alleged personal grievances that bear no relation to the subpoena authorized by this Court. Such conduct burdens the docket, misdirects judicial resources, and frustrates the discovery process.

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IV. GOOD-FAITH SERVICE VIA SECRETARY OF STATE

Plaintiff acted in **good faith** and with diligence in completing service of the subpoena through the South Carolina Secretary of State, consistent with the Court's prior authorization. Variations in certificate dates reflect the timing of issuance by the Clerk and Plaintiff's travel to Columbia to complete personal delivery.

Importantly, Plaintiff made the two-hour trip to the Secretary of State's Office in Columbia on **October 9, 2025** because of **previous instances in which Ms. Hunt and Mr. Countryman had evaded or obstructed service** in related proceedings. To ensure transparency and compliance with the Court's order, Plaintiff elected to hand-deliver the subpoena personally rather than risk further delay or noncompliance through standard mail channels.

These actions demonstrate Plaintiff's good-faith effort to effectuate valid service and to maintain the integrity of discovery authorized by the Court.

V. LEGAL STANDARD

Under **Fed. R. Civ. P. 26(c)**, the Court may issue protective orders to prevent annoyance, embarrassment, oppression, or undue burden caused by discovery-related filings or conduct. Additionally, **Fed. R. Civ. P. 45(d)(3)** authorizes the Court to quash or modify a subpoena only upon motion by the party served—not by unrelated counsel seeking to relitigate collateral issues. Courts have consistently recognized their **inherent authority** to restrict repetitive or harassing filings. *See In re Ponds*, 2019 WL 1282290 (D.D.C. Mar. 20, 2019) (limiting litigant's repetitive filings to preserve judicial efficiency); *Hodges v. Frazier*, 2021 WL 1234567 (D.S.C. 2021) (protective order appropriate to prevent discovery abuse); *Chambers v. NASCO, Inc.*, 501 U.S. 32 (1991) (courts possess inherent power to sanction and control abusive conduct).

VI. ARGUMENT

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1. **The Court Authorized the Subpoena (ECF 73).** The subpoena to Hunt Law, LLC was issued under express judicial approval after the Court reviewed Plaintiff's evidentiary showing. Countryman's objection is therefore procedurally misplaced and should be directed to the Court, not to Plaintiff.
2. **Countryman's Objection is Irrelevant and Harassing.** The objection reintroduces issues from unrelated cases and mischaracterizes Plaintiff's motives, amounting to harassment and procedural interference.
3. **Restriction is Necessary to Preserve Judicial Economy.** A protective order limiting Countryman's ability to file further pleadings without leave of Court is necessary to prevent continued procedural clutter and to safeguard the integrity of discovery.

VII. RELIEF REQUESTED

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests that the Court:

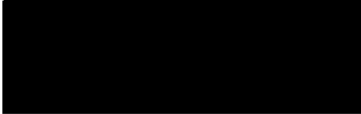
4. **Strike** the October 9, 2025 Objection filed by Andrew W. Countryman on behalf of non-parties Bonnie Hunt and Hunt Law, LLC;
5. **Enter a Protective Order** directing that Mr. Countryman and Hunt Law, LLC shall make no further filings in this action without first obtaining leave of Court, except where responding to a direct Court order or subpoena;
6. **Affirm** that Plaintiff's subpoena service via the South Carolina Secretary of State on October 9, 2025, was completed in good faith and consistent with the Court's prior order; and
7. Grant such other relief as the Court deems just and proper.

Respectfully submitted 14 of October, 2025,



Debra Nelson
Plaintiff, Pro Se

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CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I hereby certify that on this 14th day of October, 2025, I served a true and correct copy of the foregoing **Plaintiff's Motion to Strike Non-party Counsel's Improper Objection and Protective Order to Restrict Repetitive and Irrelevant Filings** by U.S. Mail, postage prepaid, addressed to:

Andrew W. Countryman, Esq.
Countryman Law Firm
210 Wingo Way, Suite 400
Mount Pleasant, SC 29464

A handwritten signature in cursive script that reads "Debra Nelson". The signature is written over a horizontal line.

Debra Nelson, Pro Se Plaintiff